

THE COMPLETE AI GUIDE TO

PROMPT RESUME

BUILD AN ATS-FRIENDLY RESUME,
OPTIMIZE **LINKEDIN** & LAND MORE INTERVIEWS
USING **AI PROMPTS**

**50+**

AI PROMPTS

Ready-to-use
prompts for every
resume section

**3**RESUME
TEMPLATES

ATS-friendly
templates for
different roles

**10+**COVER LETTER
TEMPLATES

Professional
cover letters
that get noticed

LINKEDIN
OPTIMIZATION

Headline, About,
Experience & more
with AI prompts

REVIEW &
SCORECARD

AI-powered
resume review
and scoring system

BUILD
OPTIMIZE
GET HIRED

YOUR CAREER
YOUR FUTURE



PERFECT FOR

STUDENTS | FRESHERS | INTERNS | EARLY PROFESSIONALS | JOB SEEKERS | CAREER SWITCHERS

YOUR NAME SOFTWARE ENGINEER

yourname@gmail.com | +91 12345 67890 | linkedin.com/in/yourprofile | City, Country

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven software engineer with 4+ years of experience in building scalable web applications and solving complex problems. Skilled in delivering efficient solutions and collaborating with cross-functional teams.

SKILLS

Python • JavaScript • React • Node.js • SQL • AWS • Git

EXPERIENCE

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER | ABC Tech Pvt. Ltd. Jan 2022 – Present

- Developed and maintained scalable web applications
- Improved system performance by 30% through optimization
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to deliver projects on time

SOFTWARE ENGINEER | XYZ Solutions Jun 2020 – Dec 2021

- Built RESTful APIs and integrated third-party services
- Implemented new features that improved user experience
- Wrote clean, maintainable and efficient code

EDUCATION

B.Tech in Computer Science
University Name | 2016 – 2020

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Developer – Associate
- Google IT Automation with Python
- Microsoft Azure Fundamentals

INTERVIEW CHECKLIST

- ☒ Resume
- ☒ LinkedIn
- ☒ Cover Letter
- ☒ Portfolio
- ☒ Practice

Why This Book Exists

Every year, lakhs of students graduate with the same degree, the same three projects from YouTube tutorials, and the same generic resume format copied from a Google search. Then they wonder why recruiters never reply.

The problem is rarely a lack of skill. It is almost always a lack of **translation** — the inability to turn what you know into a document, profile and outreach message that a recruiter (and the software that screens for the recruiter) can understand in under seven seconds.

This book is not a motivational pep talk. It is a system. Every chapter follows the same structure: why the topic matters, exactly what to do, a ready-to-use AI prompt, an example of what good output looks like, and a checklist to confirm you have done it correctly.

You do not need to be good at writing. You need to be good at using the prompts in this book, correctly, in order. That is the entire promise of this system.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

1. Read one chapter at a time — do not skip ahead. Each chapter builds on the last.
2. Copy the prompt exactly as written into Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, or Grok.
3. Answer the AI's clarifying questions honestly and specifically — vague answers produce vague resumes.
4. Use the Action Checklist at the end of every chapter before moving to the next one.
5. Keep one master resume in a document. Every chapter adds or refines one section of it.

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01

Understanding ATS: The Gatekeeper You Can't See

WHY IT MATTERS

Over 75% of mid-size and large companies use an Applicant Tracking System (ATS) to filter resumes before a human ever opens them. The ATS parses your file into plain text, matches it against keywords in the job description, and ranks or rejects you — often in under a second. A resume that looks beautiful to your eye can be invisible to the machine.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Save your resume as a .docx or a text-selectable PDF — never a scanned image or a design-heavy PDF from Canva.
2. Use standard section headings: Summary, Skills, Experience, Projects, Education, Certifications. ATS software is trained to look for these exact words.
3. Avoid tables, text boxes, headers/footers, and multi-column layouts — many parsers read these out of order or skip them entirely.
4. Use a single, standard font (Calibri, Arial, Georgia) at 10.5-12pt — exotic fonts sometimes fail to parse.
5. Mirror 8-12 exact keywords and phrases from the job description into your Skills and Experience sections.
6. Save the file as FirstName_LastName_Resume.pdf so it's identifiable if it's downloaded and reopened.

PRO TIPS

- Paste your resume text into a plain Notepad file. If it still reads in a logical order, an ATS can likely parse it too.
- Spell out acronyms once (e.g., 'Search Engine Optimization (SEO)') — some ATS keyword matches are literal.
- Apply within 24-48 hours of a job posting going live; many ATS platforms rank early applicants higher by default.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using a resume template with graphics, icons, or a photo in a two-column layout — columns frequently get scrambled by parsers.
- Keyword-stuffing in white text or tiny font to 'trick' the ATS — modern systems flag this and human reviewers see it immediately.
- Submitting the exact same resume to every job instead of adjusting keywords per posting.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

ATS Compatibility Checker

```
ROLE
You are an ATS (Applicant Tracking System) compatibility auditor with 10 years of experience configuring parsing engines like Workday, Greenhouse, and Taleo.

GOAL
Audit the resume text I provide and identify every element that would cause parsing errors, keyword mismatches, or formatting failures in an ATS.

CONTEXT
I am a student/fresher applying for [ROLE TITLE]. I will paste my resume text and the target job description below.

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME (if not provided)
1. What is the exact job title and job description you are targeting?
2. What file format is your resume currently saved in?
3. Does your resume use tables, columns, or graphics?

RESTRICTIONS
- Do not rewrite my resume yet — only diagnose problems.
- Do not invent skills or experience I did not mention.
- Flag every formatting risk, not just the obvious ones.

OUTPUT FORMAT
1. ATS Risk Score (0-100)
2. Formatting Issues (list, with fix for each)
3. Missing Keywords (compared against the job description, list of 10-15)
4. Section Heading Issues
5. Final Verdict: Pass / Needs Fixes / High Risk

QUALITY CHECKS
Cross-check every keyword claim against the actual job description text before listing it as missing.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I reply "go deeper on formatting" or "go deeper on keywords," expand only that section in more detail.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

ATS Risk Score: 58/100

Formatting Issues:

- Two-column skills table detected → convert to a single-column bullet list
- Header/footer contains contact info → move into the main body

Missing Keywords: "REST API," "Agile," "unit testing," "Git," "CI/CD"

Section Heading Issues: "Career Snapshot" is non-standard → rename to "Professional Summary"

Final Verdict: Needs Fixes

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Resume saved as .docx or text-selectable PDF
- ☐ No tables, columns, text boxes, or headers/footers used
- ☐ Standard section headings used throughout
- ☐ 8-12 keywords from the target job description included
- ☐ File named FirstName_LastName_Resume

ATS software is the first filter every resume must pass. A clean, single-column, keyword-matched document will always outperform a beautiful one the software cannot read.

Resume Structure: The Anatomy of a Resume That Gets Opened

WHY IT MATTERS

Recruiters spend an average of 6-8 seconds on a first pass. Structure decides whether they spend those seconds finding your best qualification — or getting confused and moving to the next resume in the pile.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

- Order sections by relevance to freshers: Header → Summary → Skills → Projects → Experience/Internships → Education → Certifications → Achievements.
- Keep the resume to one page unless you have 3+ years of experience.
- Use consistent formatting: same bullet style, same date format (MMM YYYY), same spacing between sections.
- Lead every bullet with an action verb, not a noun or 'Responsible for.'
- Leave 0.5-0.75 inch margins and 1.0-1.15 line spacing for readability without wasting space.
- Use bold sparingly — only for job titles, company names, and section headers.

PRO TIPS

- Put Projects above Experience if your projects are stronger than your internships — freshers are judged on best work, not chronology.
- Use reverse-chronological order within each section (most recent first).
- Test print your resume in black and white — many recruiters still print resumes before reviewing them.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Starting with an 'Objective' paragraph about what you want — recruiters care about what you offer, not what you want.
- Inconsistent date formats across sections (e.g., '2023' in one place and 'Jan 2023 - Present' in another).
- Cramming two pages of content onto one page using 8pt font — this destroys readability, not just design.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Resume Structure Builder

```
ROLE
You are a senior resume architect who has reviewed 5,000+ fresher resumes for recruitment consultancies.

GOAL
Design the optimal section order and page structure for my resume based on my background.

CONTEXT
I am a [YEAR/DEGREE] student targeting [ROLE/INDUSTRY]. My strongest assets are: [list projects/internships/skills].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. Do you have any internship or work experience, or only projects?
2. How many certifications and projects do you have?
3. Is your target role technical, creative, or business-focused?

RESTRICTIONS
- Recommend a one-page structure unless I confirm 3+ years experience.
- Do not suggest an "Objective" section.
- Keep advice specific to my inputs, not generic.

OUTPUT FORMAT
A section-by-section order with a one-line reason for each placement decision, followed by a spacing/formatting checklist.

QUALITY CHECKS
Ensure the strongest section (based on my input) appears within the first half of the page.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "I have no experience," reorder to lead with Projects and Skills instead of Experience.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Recommended Order:

1. Header (Name, phone, email, LinkedIn, GitHub)
2. Professional Summary (3 lines)
3. Skills (grouped: Languages / Tools / Concepts)
4. Projects (top 3, most relevant first)
5. Internship Experience
6. Education
7. Certifications

Reason: With no full-time experience, Projects placed early lets recruiters see applied skill within the first 6 seconds.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Sections ordered by relevance, strongest first
- ☐ One page (unless 3+ years experience)
- ☐ Consistent date format used throughout
- ☐ Every bullet starts with an action verb
- ☐ Margins and spacing checked for readability

Structure is not decoration — it is a sequencing decision that controls what a recruiter sees first. Lead with your strongest, most relevant material.

The AI Resume Workflow: Your End-to-End Process

WHY IT MATTERS

Most people use AI for resumes by typing "write me a resume" and getting generic, robotic output. A structured workflow — where AI asks you questions before writing — produces a resume that actually sounds like you and matches the job.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Gather raw material first: every project, internship, certificate, and skill you have, unfiltered, in a single notes document.
2. Pick ONE target job description to optimize against — do not try to write a resume for 'everything.'
3. Run the raw material and job description through an AI prompt that asks clarifying questions before drafting.
4. Draft section by section (Summary → Skills → Projects → Experience) rather than asking for a full resume in one shot.
5. Review each AI draft against the Common Mistakes list in this book before accepting it.
6. Save the finished version as your Master Resume, then create light copies per application.

PRO TIPS

- Never let AI invent a skill, tool, or outcome you didn't actually use — it will if you let it, and it will be caught in an interview.
- Feed AI your actual project code or README files for more accurate technical bullets.
- Regenerate 2-3 versions of any AI output and combine the best lines from each rather than accepting the first draft.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Asking AI to 'write my whole resume' in one prompt with no context — this produces generic filler.
- Accepting AI output word-for-word without fact-checking every claim.
- Using different AI tools for different sections without keeping a consistent tone across the document.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Master Resume Workflow Kickoff

```
ROLE
You are a career coach and resume strategist working with me one section at a time.

GOAL
Guide me through building a complete resume by collecting my raw information first, then drafting section by section.

CONTEXT
I am a student/fresher. I will paste my rough notes on education, skills, projects, and internships below. My target role is [ROLE].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. What is your target job title and one job description link/text?
2. List every project, internship, and certification you have, even rough ones.
3. What are your 3 strongest technical or soft skills?

RESTRICTIONS
- Do not fabricate any project, tool, or metric I did not mention.
- Ask questions before drafting each section — do not draft the full resume in one message.
- Keep tone confident but factual, not exaggerated.

OUTPUT FORMAT
Work in this order: Summary → Skills → Projects → Experience → Education → Certifications. Present one section, wait for my approval, then move to the next.

QUALITY CHECKS
Before presenting a section, confirm it only contains information I provided.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "make it punchier," tighten sentences without adding new claims.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

AI: Let's start with your Skills section. From your notes, I see Python, SQL, and a Power BI project. Do you have hands-on experience with any cloud platform (AWS/Azure/GCP), even a free-tier project? This affects whether we list "Cloud Fundamentals" as a skill category.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Raw material document created with all projects/skills/certs
- ☐ One target job description selected
- ☐ Resume built section-by-section, not in one shot
- ☐ Every AI claim fact-checked against your real experience
- ☐ Master Resume saved separately from job-specific copies

Treat AI as a structured interviewer, not a magic generator. The quality of your resume is a direct function of the quality of the raw material and questions you feed it.

Professional Summary: Your 3-Line First Impression

WHY IT MATTERS

The summary is the first block of text a recruiter reads. A weak, generic summary ("Hardworking and motivated fresher seeking opportunities") signals low effort and gets skipped in seconds. A strong one states your identity, top skills, and value in three lines.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Identify your role identity: what would you call yourself in one phrase (e.g., 'Final-year CSE student specializing in ML')?
2. List your 2-3 strongest, most job-relevant skills or tools.
3. Identify one measurable or concrete proof point (a project, certification, or result).
4. Combine into 3 lines: who you are → what you're skilled in → what you can prove.
5. Cut every generic adjective: 'hardworking,' 'passionate,' 'motivated,' 'team player' — show these through evidence instead.
6. Tailor the summary's skill emphasis to each job description.

PRO TIPS

- Write the summary last, after every other section is done — it's easier to summarize a finished resume than an empty one.
- Use numbers wherever possible: 'Built 3 ML projects' beats 'Experienced in machine learning.'
- Match the language of the job posting — if it says 'full-stack developer,' don't call yourself a 'web engineer.'

COMMON MISTAKES

- Writing the summary in first person ('I am a...') — resumes use implied first person, no pronouns.
- Listing every skill you have instead of the 2-3 most relevant to the target job.
- Copy-pasting a summary template from the internet without customizing it.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Professional Summary Generator

```
ROLE
You are an executive resume writer specializing in 3-line professional summaries for freshers and students.

GOAL
Write a punchy, specific, ATS-friendly 3-line professional summary.

CONTEXT
My background: [degree, year, specialization]. My top skills: [list]. My strongest proof point: [project/certification/result]. Target role: [ROLE].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. What is the exact job title you're targeting?
2. What is your single most impressive, provable achievement?
3. Do you want the tone more technical or more business-facing?

RESTRICTIONS
- No pronouns (I, my, me).
- No generic adjectives (hardworking, passionate, dynamic, motivated).
- Exactly 3 lines, under 45 words total.

OUTPUT FORMAT
Provide 3 alternative versions, each with a one-line note on what it emphasizes (technical depth / leadership / results).

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm no claim exceeds what I actually provided.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "more technical," swap soft-skill language for tools and methods.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Version 1 (Technical depth):
"Final-year B.Tech CSE student specializing in AI/ML. Built and deployed 3 end-to-end ML projects including a price-prediction system and an LLM-based planning tool. Proficient in Python, SQL, and model deployment."

Version 2 (Results-focused):

"Aspiring data professional with hands-on experience across 3 ML projects and a 30-day backend internship building REST APIs in Django. Combines technical execution with a fast learning curve."

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Exactly 3 lines, no pronouns
- ☐ 2-3 relevant skills named specifically
- ☐ One measurable proof point included
- ☐ No generic filler adjectives
- ☐ Tailored to the target job's language

Your summary is a proof statement, not a wish statement. Replace adjectives with evidence and keep it to three tight lines.

Skills Section: Signal, Not Noise

WHY IT MATTERS

Recruiters and ATS both scan the Skills section for exact keyword matches. A cluttered list of 40 skills with no grouping signals that you don't know what actually matters for the role.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Group skills into categories: Languages, Frameworks/Tools, Concepts, Soft Skills (only if space allows).
2. List only skills you can defend in an interview — remove anything you've only 'read about.'
3. Order each category by proficiency, strongest first.
4. Cross-reference the job description and add any matching keyword you genuinely possess.
5. Limit to 10-16 total skills across all categories for a one-page resume.
6. Avoid rating skills with stars or percentages — they read as arbitrary and unverifiable.

PRO TIPS

- Separate 'Tools' (e.g., Git, Power BI) from 'Languages' (e.g., Python, SQL) — recruiters scan for both differently.
- If a job description repeats a keyword 3+ times, it is very likely a required filter — make sure it's in your Skills section verbatim.
- Include one or two 'soft' technical skills like 'Agile,' 'API testing,' or 'Version control' — these are ATS keywords too.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Listing 'Microsoft Office' and 'Communication' as your top skills for a technical role — wastes prime real estate.
- Padding the list with tools you used once in a tutorial.
- Using a visual skill bar or star-rating graphic that ATS cannot parse.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Skills Section Optimizer

ROLE
You are a technical recruiter who reviews skills sections for keyword accuracy and relevance.

GOAL
Build a categorized, ATS-optimized skills section matched to a specific job description.

CONTEXT
My real skills (only list what I can defend in an interview): [list]. Target job description: [paste].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. Can you confirm you have hands-on, not just theoretical, experience with each skill listed?
2. What are the top 5 keywords repeated in the job description?
3. Do you want categories split by Languages/Tools/Concepts or a single list?

RESTRICTIONS
- Never add a skill I did not list.
- Cap the total at 16 skills for a one-page resume.
- Flag any skill that seems inflated or unverifiable.

OUTPUT FORMAT
Categorized bullet list, followed by a short note on which job-description keywords were matched and which were missing entirely.

QUALITY CHECKS
Cross-check every listed skill against my stated real skills before including it.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "trim it," remove the 3 weakest/least relevant skills first.

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Languages: Python, SQL, Java
Frameworks & Tools: Django, Power BI, Git, Postman
Concepts: REST APIs, Agile methodology, Machine Learning fundamentals

Keyword match: 6/8 job description keywords covered. Missing: "Docker," "CI/CD" — add only if genuinely experienced.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Skills grouped into clear categories
- ☐ Every skill is one you can defend in an interview
- ☐ 10-16 total skills for a one-page resume
- ☐ Job description keywords cross-checked
- ☐ No star ratings or percentage graphics used

A tight, categorized, honest skills list beats a long, unverifiable one every time — both for ATS keyword scoring and for surviving the first interview question about it.

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Projects: Where Freshers Actually Win

WHY IT MATTERS

For students and freshers with little or no work experience, projects are the single strongest proof of capability. A well-written project section can outperform a mediocre internship in a recruiter's eyes.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Pick your 3 strongest projects — quality over quantity. A 4th weak project dilutes the section.
2. For each project, write: Title + one-line description + 3 bullets (what you built, how, and the outcome).
3. Start each bullet with an action verb: Built, Designed, Deployed, Automated, Optimized.
4. Include the tech stack in brackets after the title, e.g., 'Onion Price Prediction System (Python, scikit-learn, Flask).'
5. Add a measurable outcome wherever possible: accuracy %, users, time saved, dataset size.
6. Link to GitHub or a live demo if available — recruiters do check.

PRO TIPS

- If a project was for a hackathon (like SIH), name the hackathon — it signals competitive validation.
- Frame academic/tutorial-based projects around the specific customization or extension you added, not the tutorial itself.
- Order projects by relevance to the target job, not by recency.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Writing a paragraph instead of 3 clean bullets per project.
- Describing what the project does instead of what YOU did to build it.
- Omitting the tech stack — this is one of the most-scanned parts of a project entry.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Project Bullet Generator

ROLE
You are a technical resume writer who converts raw project descriptions into resume-ready bullets.

GOAL
Turn my rough project notes into a polished project entry with title, tech stack, and 3 achievement-oriented bullets.

CONTEXT
Project name: [name]. What it does: [description]. My exact role and what I built: [details]. Tools/tech used: [list]. Any measurable result: [numbers, if any].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. What specific part did YOU build, versus your team?
2. Is there any measurable outcome (accuracy, speed, users, dataset size)?
3. Was this for a hackathon, coursework, or personal initiative?

RESTRICTIONS
- Do not invent a metric I did not provide — if none exists, write the bullet without a fabricated number.
- Every bullet must start with a strong action verb.
- Keep each bullet to one line (under 20 words).

OUTPUT FORMAT
Project Title (Tech Stack)
- Bullet 1 (what you built)
- Bullet 2 (how / technical method)
- Bullet 3 (outcome or result)

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm each bullet reflects only what I explicitly described as my contribution.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "no metric available," rewrite bullet 3 around scope or functionality instead of a number.

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Onion Price Prediction System (Python, scikit-learn, Flask, Pandas)
- Built a regression-based price prediction model using 5 years of market data

- Engineered seasonal and regional features to improve model accuracy
- Deployed the model via a Flask web app for real-time price queries

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ 3 strongest projects selected
- ☐ Tech stack listed for each
- ☐ 3 bullets per project, each starting with an action verb
- ☐ At least one measurable outcome included where possible
- ☐ GitHub/demo links added if available

Projects are your evidence locker. Write them like achievements, not descriptions — what you built, how, and what it proved.

Experience & Internships: Proving You Can Deliver

WHY IT MATTERS

Even a 30-day internship can carry significant weight if it's described in terms of ownership and outcome rather than task lists. This is where recruiters look for signs of real-world accountability.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. State company, role, dates, and location in a consistent header format.
2. Write 3-4 bullets using the STAR-lite pattern: Situation/Task → Action → Result.
3. Quantify wherever possible: number of features shipped, bugs fixed, tickets closed, APIs built.
4. Focus on outcomes and ownership, not a list of daily duties.
5. If the internship was short (under 2 months), don't hide it — frame it around what you completed within that window.
6. Use present tense only for a current role; past tense for everything else.

PRO TIPS

- 'Built 4 REST API endpoints for a Django-based internal tool' beats 'Worked on backend development' every time.
- If you contributed to a team project, still write from your individual contribution, not 'we.'
- Mention any code review, mentorship, or documentation you contributed to — these signal collaboration skill.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Writing bullets as a duty list ('Responsible for testing') instead of an outcome ('Reduced bug reports by testing 15+ edge cases').
- Hiding a short internship's dates out of embarrassment — recruiters respect honesty more than they penalize brevity.
- Using passive voice throughout ('Was involved in...') instead of active voice ('Built...', 'Led...').

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Internship/Experience Bullet Writer

```
ROLE
You are a resume writer specializing in turning internship experiences into outcome-driven bullets for freshers.

GOAL
Convert my rough internship notes into 3-4 STAR-lite formatted bullets.

CONTEXT
Company: [name]. Role: [title]. Duration: [dates]. What I actually did day-to-day: [notes]. Any tools/tech used: [list]. Any measurable outcome: [numbers, if known].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. What is one specific thing you built, fixed, or delivered independently?
2. Did you work with any tools, frameworks, or languages I should name explicitly?
3. Is there any number I can attach to the outcome (tickets, features, time, accuracy)?

RESTRICTIONS
- Do not fabricate metrics.
- Use active voice and strong action verbs only.
- Do not pad with generic phrases like "gained valuable experience."

OUTPUT FORMAT
Company Name — Role (Month Year - Month Year)
- Bullet 1
- Bullet 2
- Bullet 3

QUALITY CHECKS
Every bullet must reflect a specific action, not a vague responsibility.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "shorter internship, less to show," focus bullets on 1-2 concrete deliverables instead of forcing 4.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Prodesk IT & Engineering Services — Backend Development Intern (Jun 2024 - Jul 2024)

- Built 3 REST API endpoints in Django to support internal reporting tools
- Wrote unit tests for core endpoints, reducing post-deployment bugs
- Collaborated with a 4-member team using Git for version control and code review

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Company, role, and dates formatted consistently
- ☐ 3-4 STAR-lite bullets written per role
- ☐ At least one quantified result where possible
- ☐ Active voice used throughout
- ☐ No duty-list language ('Responsible for...')

Experience sections should read like a record of delivery, not a job description. Show what you shipped, not what you were assigned.

Certificates & Courses: Proof of Self-Direction

WHY IT MATTERS

Certifications signal initiative — that you learn beyond the classroom. But an unfiltered list of 15 free course certificates dilutes credibility. Curation matters more than volume.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. List only certifications relevant to your target role or that come from a recognized provider (NPTEL, Coursera, AWS, Google, Microsoft).
2. Format: Certificate Name — Issuing Platform (Month Year).
3. Group multiple short certificates from the same platform if space is tight (e.g., 'NPTEL: 4 certifications in DBMS, SE, Cloud Computing, Data Structures').
4. Skip certificates unrelated to your target role, even if impressive elsewhere.
5. Add a one-line note only if the certificate involved a graded project or exam — this adds credibility.
6. Keep this section to 4-6 lines maximum on a one-page resume.

PRO TIPS

- NPTEL, university, and vendor (AWS/Google/Microsoft) certifications carry more ATS and recruiter trust than generic online-course badges.
- If you have many certificates, create a separate 'Certifications' page linked from your LinkedIn instead of cramming all onto the resume.
- Mention if a certification was 'with distinction' or top percentile — this is a differentiator worth the extra words.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Listing every single free certificate you've ever completed.
- Failing to mention the issuing platform, which makes the certificate unverifiable and low-trust.
- Including expired or outdated certifications with no continued relevance.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Certification Section Curator

ROLE
You are a recruiter reviewing certifications for relevance and credibility.

GOAL
Curate and format my certifications list into a tight, high-trust resume section.

CONTEXT
My full certification list: [paste all, unfiltered]. Target role: [ROLE].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. Which of these involved a graded exam or project versus just video completion?
2. Which are most relevant to your target role?
3. Do you want to group similar certifications (e.g., all NPTEL) into one line?

RESTRICTIONS
- Do not include more than 6 lines in the final section.
- Prioritize recognized providers (NPTEL, AWS, Google, Microsoft, Coursera) over unbranded platforms.
- Do not remove a certification without explaining why.

OUTPUT FORMAT
A curated bullet list of certifications with platform and date, plus a short note on which ones were excluded and why.

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm the final list is ranked by relevance to the target role, most relevant first.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "I have too many," keep only the top 4 most relevant plus one grouped line for the rest.

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Certifications:

- NPTEL: Software Engineering, Database Management Systems (2024)
- AWS Cloud Practitioner Essentials — AWS Skill Builder (2024)
- Machine Learning Specialization — Coursera / Stanford (2023)

Excluded: 3 generic "Introduction to Excel" style certificates — low relevance to target ML/backend roles.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Only relevant, recognized certifications included
- ☐ Format consistent: Name - Platform (Date)
- ☐ Similar certificates grouped where sensible
- ☐ Section limited to 4-6 lines
- ☐ Irrelevant/expired certificates removed

Curate, don't collect. A short list of credible, relevant certifications says more about your judgment than a long list of everything you've ever clicked 'enroll' on.

Achievements & Awards: Proof of Standing Out

WHY IT MATTERS

Achievements differentiate you from hundreds of resumes with identical degrees and similar projects. Even small-scale wins — a hackathon rank, a scholarship, a leadership role — build credibility when framed correctly.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. List achievements that show competition, leadership, or recognition — not just participation.
2. Quantify rank or scale wherever possible: 'Top 10 of 200 teams,' 'Selected among 500 applicants.'
3. Include academic honors (dean's list, scholarships, top percentile) if relevant.
4. Include leadership roles (club head, event organizer) with one outcome-based line.
5. Keep this section to 3-5 bullets; cut anything that requires long explanation.
6. Place this section near the end of the resume unless an achievement is your single strongest asset.

PRO TIPS

- 'Winner, Smart India Hackathon (Top 6 of 250+ teams)' is far stronger than 'Participated in SIH.'
- If you don't have big awards, reframe consistent effort as achievement: 'Maintained 9+ CGPA across 6 semesters.'
- Avoid vague claims like 'Recognized for excellence' — always name what, from whom, and at what scale.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Listing participation certificates as 'achievements' — recruiters distinguish between winning and attending.
- Omitting scale/rank information that would make an average-sounding achievement much stronger.
- Overloading this section at the expense of Projects or Skills, which usually matter more for freshers.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Achievements Section Builder

```
ROLE
You are a resume writer specializing in framing achievements with maximum credibility and impact.

GOAL
Turn my raw list of achievements into 3-5 sharp, quantified bullet points.

CONTEXT
My achievements (unfiltered): [list hackathons, awards, ranks, scholarships, leadership roles].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. For each achievement, what was the scale (number of participants/teams/applicants)?
2. Which of these are competitive wins versus participation?
3. Do you have any consistent academic metric (CGPA, top percentile) worth including?

RESTRICTIONS
- Do not claim "winner" or "top rank" unless I explicitly confirm it.
- Every bullet must include scale or rank if available.
- Limit output to 5 bullets maximum.

OUTPUT FORMAT
A ranked bullet list, strongest achievement first, each one line long.

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm every quantified claim (rank, scale, percentile) matches exactly what I provided.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "no big awards," reframe consistency and effort-based achievements instead of competitive wins.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

- Winner, Smart India Hackathon (SIH) — Top team among 250+ registered nationally
- Maintained 9.1 CGPA across 6 semesters in B.Tech CSE (AI & ML)
- Selected as Technical Lead for university coding club (40+ members)

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Only competitive or verifiably notable items included
- ☐ Rank/scale included wherever possible
- ☐ 3-5 bullets maximum
- ☐ No vague, unquantified claims
- ☐ Section placed appropriately in the resume flow

An achievement without scale is just a claim. Add the number that shows what you beat or who noticed — that's what makes it credible.

Professional Photo: Rules for LinkedIn and Beyond

WHY IT MATTERS

While Indian resumes traditionally include photos, most modern ATS-first resumes should not. LinkedIn, however, absolutely should — profiles with a professional photo get significantly more recruiter views and connection acceptances.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Do NOT include a photo on your ATS resume — it adds parsing risk and is not expected in tech/corporate hiring in most markets.
2. DO include a professional photo on LinkedIn — a plain background, front-facing, shoulders-up shot.
3. Wear what you'd wear to an interview — business casual at minimum.
4. Ensure even, natural lighting — avoid harsh flash or backlit shots.
5. Smile naturally; avoid overly posed or filtered images.
6. Crop so your face takes up 60-70% of the frame, centered.

PRO TIPS

- Use a plain wall or blurred outdoor background — busy backgrounds distract from your face.
- Ask a friend to take multiple shots in the same setup and pick the most natural-looking one, not the most 'posed' one.
- Update your photo every 1-2 years or after a major appearance change — outdated photos hurt trust in interviews.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using a cropped group photo where your friend's arm is still visible.
- Using a heavily filtered or edited photo that looks noticeably different from how you appear in person.
- Putting a casual selfie or party photo as your LinkedIn profile picture.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Professional Photo Brief Generator

ROLE
You are a personal branding consultant advising on professional photography for LinkedIn.

GOAL
Give me a specific shot list and styling brief I can follow for a DIY or studio photo session.

CONTEXT
I am a student/fresher targeting [industry, e.g., tech/corporate/creative]. I will take this photo [at home with a phone / at a studio].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. Will this be shot at home or with a professional camera/studio?
2. What industry are you targeting (affects formality of dress)?
3. Do you have access to natural window light or need artificial lighting tips?

RESTRICTIONS
- Recommend only realistic, achievable setups for a student budget.
- Do not suggest heavy filters or editing beyond basic brightness/contrast.

OUTPUT FORMAT
1. Outfit guidance
2. Background & lighting setup
3. Pose & framing instructions
4. Post-processing dos and don'ts

QUALITY CHECKS
Ensure every recommendation is achievable with a smartphone camera if that's my stated setup.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "studio shoot," add guidance on communicating the brief to a photographer.

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Outfit: Collared shirt or blazer in a solid, neutral color (navy, white, grey).
Background: Plain wall, or outdoors with a blurred natural backdrop (use portrait mode).
Lighting: Face a window; avoid direct overhead light causing shadows.

Framing: Shoulders-up, face centered, camera at eye level (not below chin).
Editing: Adjust brightness/contrast only — avoid beauty filters.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ No photo included on ATS resume
- ☐ Professional photo added to LinkedIn
- ☐ Plain background, even lighting used
- ☐ Business-casual or formal attire worn
- ☐ Face fills 60-70% of frame, natural expression

Skip the photo on your resume; invest the effort into a clean, professional LinkedIn photo instead — that's where it actually moves the needle on recruiter engagement.

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LinkedIn Optimization: Your 24/7 Resume

WHY IT MATTERS

Recruiters search LinkedIn using keywords, just like an ATS scans a resume. An incomplete or generic profile is invisible in recruiter search results, no matter how good your actual resume is.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Write a headline beyond your job title: 'CSE Student | AI/ML | Python, SQL | Building ML Projects' — packed with searchable keywords.
2. Fill the 'About' section with a 3-4 paragraph story: who you are, what you've built, what you're looking for.
3. List every project and internship under 'Experience' and 'Featured,' even student ones — mirror your resume content, not word-for-word.
4. Add all your skills (LinkedIn allows up to 50) and pin your top 3 most relevant to the top.
5. Request skill endorsements and recommendations from professors, mentors, or internship supervisors.
6. Turn on '#OpenToWork' visible to recruiters only, and set your target job titles.

PRO TIPS

- Post 1-2 times a month about a project or learning milestone — activity increases your visibility in recruiter searches significantly.
- Use the custom LinkedIn URL feature (linkedin.com/in/yourname) instead of the default number string.
- Join and engage in 3-5 relevant LinkedIn groups or follow target companies to appear more active to profile visitors.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaving the headline as just your current job title or 'Student at [University]' with no keywords.
- Leaving the 'About' section blank or copy-pasting your resume summary verbatim.
- Connecting with recruiters with no personalized note, which lowers acceptance rates significantly.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

LinkedIn Profile Optimizer

```
ROLE
You are a LinkedIn branding strategist who has optimized 1,000+ student and fresher profiles for recruiter visibility.

GOAL
Write an optimized LinkedIn headline and About section based on my resume content.

CONTEXT
My resume summary: [paste]. My skills: [list]. My projects: [list]. Target role: [ROLE].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. What 3-5 keywords do recruiters in your target field search for most?
2. Do you want your About section to sound more technical or more personable/story-driven?
3. Are you open to relocation or remote work? (affects headline)

RESTRICTIONS
- Headline must stay under 220 characters.
- About section: 4 short paragraphs, no walls of text.
- No generic phrases like "passionate lifelong learner."

OUTPUT FORMAT
1. Headline (with 2 alternate versions)
2. About section (full draft)
3. List of 15 skills to add, ranked by relevance

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm the headline includes at least 4 searchable keywords.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "more personable," add one line of personal motivation/story into the About section's opening.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Headline: "Final-Year CSE Student | AI/ML & Data | Python, SQL, GenAI |

Open to Fresher & Internship Roles"

About (opening): "I build things that turn data into decisions. Over the past year I've shipped 3 ML projects — from an onion price predictor to an LLM-based trip planner — while completing a backend internship building REST APIs in Django..."

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Keyword-rich headline (not just job title)
- ☐ About section written in 4 short paragraphs
- ☐ All projects and internships added to Experience/Featured
- ☐ Top skills pinned, 40+ skills added
- ☐ Custom LinkedIn URL set, #OpenToWork configured

LinkedIn is not a copy of your resume — it's a searchable, always-on version of it. Optimize for keywords and activity, not just completeness.

Cover Letters: The Underused Differentiator

WHY IT MATTERS

Most freshers skip cover letters, assuming they don't matter. In competitive applications, a sharp, specific cover letter is one of the few chances to show genuine interest in a **specific** company, not just a job title.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Research the company for one specific detail — a product, value, or recent news — to reference.
2. Open with why THIS company, not a generic 'I am writing to apply for...' line.
3. Middle paragraph: connect 1-2 of your strongest projects/experiences directly to their stated needs.
4. Close with a confident, specific call to action — not a passive 'I hope to hear from you.'
5. Keep it to 250-350 words, 3-4 short paragraphs — never more than one page.
6. Match the tone of the company (formal for corporates, more casual for startups) based on their website/careers page.

PRO TIPS

- Only write a full cover letter when the application allows/requests one — don't force it into a portal with no field for it.
- Reuse a strong structural template, but always personalize the opening and one company-specific line.
- Avoid restating your resume — the cover letter should add context/story, not repeat bullet points.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using 'Dear Sir/Madam' or 'To Whom It May Concern' when the hiring manager's name is findable on LinkedIn.
- Writing a generic letter that could be sent to any company with just the name swapped.
- Making it about what you want ('This opportunity would help my career') instead of what you offer.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Cover Letter Writer

```
ROLE
You are a cover letter specialist who writes concise, company-specific letters for students and freshers.

GOAL
Write a 250-350 word cover letter connecting my background to a specific company and role.

CONTEXT
Company: [name]. Role: [title]. One specific thing I know/like about the company: [detail]. My most relevant project/experience: [details]. Job description: [paste].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. Do you know the hiring manager's name, or should I use a role-based greeting?
2. What is the ONE experience of yours most relevant to this specific role?
3. Should the tone be formal (corporate) or conversational (startup)?

RESTRICTIONS
- Maximum 350 words.
- No restating resume bullets word-for-word.
- No generic opening or closing lines.

OUTPUT FORMAT
Full cover letter, 3-4 paragraphs, ready to paste into an application, followed by a subject line suggestion if sent by email.

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm the letter references at least one company-specific detail, not just the role title.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "more startup tone," shorten sentences and reduce formality by about 20%.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Dear Ms. Sharma,

OMAV Technology's focus on SAP consulting for mid-size manufacturers caught my attention — particularly your recent expansion into SAP EWM

implementations. As a final-year CSE student who has spent the past year building both ABAP-based reports and ML-driven prediction systems, I understand both the enterprise and data sides of the problems your clients face.

In my most recent project, I built an end-to-end price-prediction system using Python and scikit-learn, handling everything from data cleaning to deployment — the same kind of ownership I'd bring to a fresher role on your team...

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ One company-specific detail referenced
- ☐ 250-350 words, 3-4 paragraphs
- ☐ Named greeting used where possible
- ☐ No resume bullets repeated verbatim
- ☐ Confident, specific closing call to action

A cover letter's job is to prove you did your homework on this one company. Specificity beats politeness every time.

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Recruiter Cold Emails: Getting a Reply, Not the Inbox Trash

WHY IT MATTERS

Applying only through portals means competing with hundreds of identical applicants. A well-crafted cold email directly to a recruiter or hiring manager can bypass the pile entirely — if it respects their time.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Find the recruiter or hiring manager's email via LinkedIn, company website, or verified email-finder tools.
2. Write a subject line that states purpose and value in under 8 words.
3. Open with a one-line hook — how you found them or a specific connection to their work.
4. State your ask clearly in 1-2 sentences: what role, and why you're a fit.
5. Attach your resume as a PDF; do not paste the entire resume into the email body.
6. Close with a low-friction call to action: 'Happy to share more — could we connect for 10 minutes?'

PRO TIPS

- Send cold emails Tuesday-Thursday, 9-11 AM — response rates are measurably higher outside Mondays and Fridays.
- Keep the entire email under 120 words — recruiters skim, they don't read.
- Follow up once, after 4-5 business days, with a short one-line bump — not a repeat of the original email.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Sending a mass, unpersonalized email to 50 recruiters with the same generic opening line.
- Writing a 300-word essay about your entire life story.
- Forgetting to attach the resume, or attaching it as an uneditable image file.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Recruiter Cold Email Generator

```
ROLE
You are an outreach specialist who writes high-response-rate cold emails to recruiters for students and freshers.

GOAL
Write a concise, personalized cold email under 120 words with a clear ask.

CONTEXT
Recruiter/company: [name]. Role I'm interested in: [title]. Why I'm reaching out to them specifically: [detail — e.g., their recent post, the company's work]. My one strongest relevant point: [detail].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. Do you have any real connection point (mutual contact, their content, event) to reference?
2. What is the single strongest reason you're a fit for this specific role?
3. Do you want to ask for a referral, an interview, or just to be considered?

RESTRICTIONS
- Under 120 words total.
- No generic openers ("I hope this email finds you well").
- One clear, low-friction ask only.

OUTPUT FORMAT
Subject line + email body, ready to send.

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm the email contains one specific, non-generic personalization detail.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "asking for a referral instead," rewrite the ask paragraph to request a referral rather than direct consideration.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Subject: Fresher ML Background — Interested in [Company]'s Data Team

Hi Ankit,

I came across your post about [Company]'s expansion into predictive analytics — that's exactly the space I've been building in. I'm a final-year CSE (AI/ML) student who's shipped 3 end-to-end ML projects, including a deployed price-prediction system.

I'd love to be considered for any fresher/intern openings on your data team. Resume attached — happy to share more on a quick call if useful.

Best,
Daksh

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Subject line under 8 words, purpose clear
- ☐ Under 120 words total
- ☐ One specific personalization detail included
- ☐ Resume attached as PDF
- ☐ Single, clear, low-friction call to action

A cold email's only job is to earn 15 more seconds of attention. Be short, specific, and easy to say yes to.

LinkedIn DMs & Networking: Building Warm Connections

WHY IT MATTERS

Referrals dramatically increase interview odds — some studies suggest referred candidates are far more likely to get hired than cold applicants. LinkedIn DMs are the modern way to build that warm path in.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Identify 10-15 target people: alumni, current employees, recruiters at target companies.
2. Send a connection request with a short, specific note (under 300 characters) — never blank.
3. After they accept, wait 1-2 days, then send a short, genuine message — don't ask for a job in the first message.
4. Ask a specific, easy-to-answer question: about their role, team culture, or advice for freshers.
5. After a good conversation, THEN ask if they'd be open to referring you if a relevant role opens.
6. Always thank them, regardless of outcome — this is a long-term relationship, not a one-time transaction.

PRO TIPS

- Alumni from your own college respond at a noticeably higher rate — lead with that connection point.
- Engage with their posts (thoughtful comments, not just likes) before DMing — this warms the relationship first.
- Keep a simple tracker of who you've messaged and the outcome, so you don't lose track or repeat outreach.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Asking for a referral or job in the very first message — this reads as transactional and gets ignored.
- Sending the same copy-pasted message to 40 people without any personalization.
- Going silent after getting help — never following up to say thanks or share the outcome.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

LinkedIn Networking DM Writer

```
ROLE
You are a networking coach who writes warm, non-transactional LinkedIn outreach messages for students.

GOAL
Write a connection request note and a genuine first DM for building a relationship with a target professional.

CONTEXT
Person: [name, role, company]. Our connection point: [alumni/mutual group/shared interest]. My goal: [advice/insight/eventual referral].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. What genuinely specific connection do you have with this person?
2. What is one specific question you'd actually want answered by them?
3. Is this a first-touch message or a follow-up after they accepted?

RESTRICTIONS
- Connection note under 300 characters.
- First DM must not ask for a job or referral directly.
- Keep tone warm, not overly formal or robotic.

OUTPUT FORMAT
1. Connection request note
2. First DM (post-acceptance)
3. Optional follow-up message template (for after a good conversation)

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm no message in the sequence directly asks for a job before message 3.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "we already connected," skip straight to the first DM and follow-up templates.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Connection note: "Hi Priya, fellow MRU CSE grad here (batch of 2026). Would love to connect and learn a bit about your path into data analytics!"

First DM: "Thanks for connecting! I saw you've been at [Company] for about a year now — I'm exploring data/ML roles as a final-year student and would love to hear what a typical week looks like on your team, whenever you have a spare few minutes."

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ 10-15 target people identified
- ☐ Personalized connection note sent (not blank)
- ☐ First DM does not ask for a job directly
- ☐ Specific, easy-to-answer question included
- ☐ Thank-you sent regardless of outcome

Networking is relationship-building, not transaction-hunting. Lead with genuine curiosity, and the referral conversation follows naturally later.

Resume Review: Auditing Before You Apply

WHY IT MATTERS

Most people submit their resume after writing it once. A structured self-review — or AI-assisted review — catches the errors and weaknesses that a first draft always has, before a recruiter ever sees them.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Read your resume out loud — awkward phrasing becomes obvious when spoken.
2. Check every bullet: does it start with an action verb and show outcome, not just task?
3. Verify every date, tool, and number is 100% accurate — inconsistencies raise credibility flags.
4. Run a keyword check against your target job description.
5. Get one human review from a mentor, senior, or peer — a second pair of eyes always finds something.
6. Do a final formatting pass: fonts, spacing, alignment, file naming.

PRO TIPS

- Review your resume at least 24 hours after writing it — fresh eyes catch far more errors than same-day review.
- Check for tense consistency: past roles in past tense, current role in present tense.
- Use Ctrl+F to check for the words 'responsible for' and 'helped with' — replace both with stronger action verbs.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Submitting a resume immediately after finishing it, with zero review pass.
- Only checking for typos and missing bigger structural or content weaknesses.
- Ignoring feedback from a reviewer because it requires rewriting a section you like.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Resume Review Auditor

```
ROLE
You are a strict but constructive senior recruiter conducting a final resume review before submission.

GOAL
Review my resume for content strength, ATS compatibility, and professionalism, and give a prioritized action list.

CONTEXT
[Paste full resume text.] Target role: [ROLE].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. What specific job are you applying to with this version?
2. Is this your first review pass or a revision after previous feedback?
3. Do you want a strict/harsh tone or an encouraging/constructive one?

RESTRICTIONS
- Be specific — cite the exact bullet or line with each critique.
- Do not just say "make it stronger" — explain how.
- Separate must-fix issues from nice-to-have polish.

OUTPUT FORMAT
1. Overall impression (2-3 sentences)
2. Must-Fix Issues (numbered, with the exact fix)
3. Nice-to-Have Polish
4. Final Readiness Score (out of 10)

QUALITY CHECKS
Ensure every critique references an actual line from the resume provided, not a generic comment.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "just check ATS compatibility," skip content critique and focus only on formatting/keyword issues.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Overall impression: Strong technical foundation, but the summary and two experience bullets rely on task-listing rather than outcomes.

- Must-Fix Issues:
- 1. Bullet "Worked on backend features" → rewrite with a specific feature and outcome.
 - 2. Summary uses "hardworking" → replace with a concrete skill/proof point.

Readiness Score: 7/10

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Resume read aloud for phrasing check
- ☐ Every bullet checked for action verb + outcome
- ☐ Dates, tools, and numbers verified for accuracy
- ☐ Keyword check run against target job description
- ☐ At least one human review completed

A resume is never done after the first draft — it's done after a structured review. Build the review step into your process every time.

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Resume Scorecard: Measuring What Matters

WHY IT MATTERS

Vague feedback like 'looks good' or 'needs work' isn't actionable. A scorecard forces specific, measurable evaluation across the dimensions that actually predict resume success.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

- Score each dimension out of 10: ATS Compatibility, Structure, Summary Strength, Skills Relevance, Project/Experience Impact, Achievements, Formatting.
- Add a one-line justification for every score — this prevents lazy scoring.
- Calculate a total out of 70 and convert to a percentage.
- Identify the single lowest-scoring dimension — fix that first, not the easiest one.
- Re-score after every major revision to track improvement.
- Aim for 85%+ before submitting to competitive roles.

PRO TIPS

- Score honestly, not optimistically — the scorecard is only useful if it's accurate.
- Compare scores across resume versions to confirm you're actually improving, not just changing.
- Have someone else run the scorecard on your resume too — self-scoring has blind spots.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Scoring every category an 8 or 9 out of politeness or bias toward your own work.
- Fixing the highest-scoring section because it's easiest, instead of the lowest-scoring one.
- Scoring once and never re-checking after edits.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Resume Scorecard Generator

```
ROLE
You are a resume evaluator using a strict 7-category scorecard system.

GOAL
Score my resume out of 10 in each of 7 categories with justification, then calculate a total percentage.

CONTEXT
[Paste full resume text.] Target role: [ROLE].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. What role/industry should this be scored against?
2. Is there a specific category you're most worried about?

RESTRICTIONS
- Score each category independently — don't let one weak area drag down an unrelated score.
- Justify every score in one sentence, citing specific resume content.
- Do not round scores up out of politeness.

OUTPUT FORMAT
Table: Category | Score /10 | Justification
Then: Total /70, Percentage, and "Fix This First" recommendation.

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm the "Fix This First" recommendation matches the actual lowest score.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I paste a revised resume, re-score and show the score delta per category.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

ATS Compatibility: 8/10 - clean single column, minor missing keyword
Structure: 7/10 - strong order, spacing slightly inconsistent
Summary Strength: 5/10 - contains one generic adjective, needs a metric
Skills Relevance: 8/10

Project Impact: 9/10
Achievements: 6/10 - no scale/rank mentioned
Formatting: 8/10
Total: 51/70 (73%) — Fix This First: Summary Strength

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ All 7 categories scored with justification
- ☐ Total and percentage calculated
- ☐ Lowest-scoring category identified as priority
- ☐ Re-scored after major revisions
- ☐ Target: 85%+ before submission to competitive roles

What gets measured gets fixed. A scorecard turns vague self-doubt into a specific, prioritized action plan.

Resume Rewrite: From Weak Draft to Strong Draft

WHY IT MATTERS

Most first drafts are functional but flat. Rewriting is a distinct skill from writing — it's about tightening, quantifying, and injecting specificity into what already exists rather than starting over.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Identify every generic phrase ('team player,' 'hard worker,' 'responsible for') and mark it for removal.
2. For each bullet, ask: 'So what?' — if the bullet doesn't answer why it mattered, rewrite it.
3. Replace passive constructions with active, ownership-driven language.
4. Add a number or scale to every bullet where one exists but wasn't included.
5. Cut any sentence that could apply to literally any other candidate — it's not doing any work.
6. Read the final version against the job description one more time for keyword alignment.

PRO TIPS

- Rewrite in passes: one pass for content/specificity, a separate pass for grammar/polish — don't mix the two.
- Compare your 'before' and 'after' bullets side by side — if they don't look meaningfully different, rewrite again.
- Keep a swipe file of strong action verbs (Built, Led, Automated, Reduced, Designed, Launched) to pull from.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rewriting by adding more words instead of more specificity — length isn't the same as strength.
- Losing your authentic voice by over-relying on AI-generated corporate jargon.
- Rewriting once and considering it final without a second comparison pass.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Resume Rewrite Engine

```
ROLE
You are a resume rewriting specialist who transforms flat, generic bullets into specific, high-impact ones.

GOAL
Rewrite the weak bullets I provide into stronger versions using the "so what?" test and quantification.

CONTEXT
Weak bullets: [paste]. Additional context on what I actually did/achieved for each: [details].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. For each weak bullet, what was the actual outcome or "so what"?
2. Is there any number, scale, or result I'm leaving out?
3. Do you want the tone more technical or more business-impact focused?

RESTRICTIONS
- Do not add any fact, tool, or number I did not confirm.
- Show the before and after version side by side.
- Keep each rewritten bullet to one line.

OUTPUT FORMAT
For each bullet:
BEFORE: [original]
AFTER: [rewritten]
WHY IT'S STRONGER: [one line]

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm every AFTER bullet passes the "so what?" test — it must show impact, not just activity.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "still too generic," ask me one more clarifying question about scale or outcome before rewriting again.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

BEFORE: "Responsible for testing the application"
AFTER: "Tested 15+ edge cases across core app features, reducing

post-release bug reports by identifying issues pre-launch"

WHY IT'S STRONGER: Shows scope (15+ cases) and outcome (fewer bugs) instead of just naming the task.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Every generic phrase identified and flagged
- ☐ Each bullet passes the 'so what?' test
- ☐ Passive language converted to active
- ☐ Numbers/scale added wherever available
- ☐ Final pass checked against job description keywords

Rewriting is about specificity, not length. Every bullet should survive the question: 'So what did that actually achieve?'

18

Bullet Point Generator: The One Prompt You'll Use Most

WHY IT MATTERS

You will write dozens of bullets across resume versions, LinkedIn, and applications. Having one reliable, repeatable bullet-generation process saves enormous time and keeps quality consistent.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Gather the raw facts: what you did, how, tools used, and any outcome.
2. Choose the bullet's opening action verb based on the type of work (Built, Automated, Led, Analyzed, Designed).
3. Structure: [Action verb] + [what you did] + [how/tools] + [outcome/result].
4. Keep every bullet to one line, ideally under 20 words.
5. Generate 2-3 variations and pick the tightest, most specific one.
6. Slot the chosen bullet into the correct resume section.

PRO TIPS

- Different bullets for different audiences: a technical recruiter wants tools named; a business recruiter wants outcomes named.
- Avoid starting more than 2 bullets in the same section with the same verb — vary your openings.
- Keep raw, unedited notes on every project/task as you complete them — future bullet-writing becomes far easier.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Writing bullets that describe the project instead of your specific contribution.
- Using the same 2-3 action verbs for every single bullet across the whole resume.
- Making bullets too long (2+ lines) — recruiters skim, they don't read paragraphs.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Universal Bullet Point Generator

```
ROLE
You are a resume bullet-writing specialist trained on the formula: Action Verb + What + How + Result.

GOAL
Generate 3 tight, resume-ready bullet variations from my raw notes.

CONTEXT
Raw notes on what I did: [paste rough notes, any format]. Section this belongs to: [Project/Experience/Achievement]. Any measurable result: [numbers, if known].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. What tools/technologies should be explicitly named?
2. Is there a number or scale I haven't mentioned yet?
3. Should this lean more technical or more business-impact in tone?

RESTRICTIONS
- Each bullet must be one line, under 20 words.
- Do not invent any detail not present in my notes.
- Use a different action verb for each of the 3 variations.

OUTPUT FORMAT
3 bullet variations, each with a different action verb and slight framing difference, followed by a one-line recommendation on which to use and why.

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm each bullet follows Action Verb + What + How + Result structure.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "no result yet," generate variations that emphasize scope or method instead of outcome.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

1. "Automated data-cleaning pipeline using Python/Pandas, cutting manual prep time for weekly reports"
2. "Built a Python-based automation script to clean and structure raw

weekly report data"

3. "Designed a reusable Pandas pipeline to standardize inconsistent weekly data exports"

Recommendation: Use #1 – it's the only version with a stated outcome (time saved).

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Raw facts gathered before writing
- ☐ Bullet follows Action Verb + What + How + Result
- ☐ Under 20 words, one line only
- ☐ 3 variations generated, strongest one selected
- ☐ Varied action verbs used across the resume

One formula, endlessly reusable: Action Verb + What + How + Result. Master this and every bullet you write gets faster and stronger.

ATS Keyword Optimizer: Speaking the Machine's Language

WHY IT MATTERS

Even a well-written resume fails silently if it's missing the specific keywords an ATS is configured to search for. Keyword optimization is a distinct, mechanical step separate from good writing.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Paste the full job description into a keyword extraction prompt or highlight every noun/skill mentioned.
2. Separate keywords into: hard skills (tools, languages), soft skills, and qualifications (degree, years of experience).
3. Check your resume for each keyword — note which are present, missing, or only partially matched.
4. Naturally insert missing keywords into Skills, Summary, or relevant bullets — never force an unnatural sentence.
5. Never add a keyword for a skill you don't actually have — this fails at interview stage.
6. Repeat this process for every new job application, not just once.

PRO TIPS

- Keywords mentioned 2-3+ times in a job description are almost always required filters, not nice-to-haves.
- Match both the acronym and full form once (e.g., 'Search Engine Optimization (SEO)') for maximum ATS coverage.
- Job titles matter too — if the posting says 'Software Engineer I' and your resume says 'Developer,' consider aligning the language.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Copying the entire job description into your resume as a 'skills' block — this reads as spam to both ATS and humans.
- Ignoring keyword frequency and treating every mentioned word as equally important.
- Adding keywords for tools/skills you cannot speak to in an interview.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

ATS Keyword Extractor & Matcher

```
ROLE
You are an ATS keyword analyst who reverse-engineers job descriptions into ranked keyword lists.

GOAL
Extract and rank the most important keywords from a job description, then match them against my resume.

CONTEXT
Job description: [paste full text]. My resume: [paste full text].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. Do you actually have hands-on experience with each "missing" keyword I flag, or only some?
2. Do you want keywords ranked by frequency or by apparent importance (e.g., "required" vs "nice to have")?

RESTRICTIONS
- Do not recommend adding any keyword without me confirming real experience with it.
- Rank keywords by how many times they appear or how prominently they're framed (required vs. preferred).
- Separate hard skills, soft skills, and qualifications into distinct lists.

OUTPUT FORMAT
1. Ranked Keyword List (Hard Skills / Soft Skills / Qualifications)
2. Present in Resume ✓
3. Missing from Resume △
4. Suggested natural placement for each missing keyword (which section)

QUALITY CHECKS
Cross-check every "present" marking against the actual resume text before confirming it.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I confirm real experience with a missing keyword, suggest the exact bullet or skills-line placement.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Hard Skills (ranked): SQL (5x), Python (4x), REST API (3x), Docker (2x)
Present ✓: SQL, Python
Missing △: REST API, Docker

Suggested placement: Add "REST API" to Skills > Concepts, and to the Prodesk internship bullet if you built any endpoints there.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Job description keywords extracted and ranked
- ☐ Keywords cross-checked against current resume
- ☐ Only genuinely-possessed missing keywords added
- ☐ Both acronym and full form used once where relevant
- ☐ Process repeated per new application, not reused blindly

Keyword optimization is mechanical, not creative — extract, compare, and honestly fill the gaps. Never claim a skill the keyword implies you don't have.

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Grammar & Humanization: Sounding Like a Person, Not a Bot

WHY IT MATTERS

AI-assisted resumes often carry a distinct robotic tone — overly formal, repetitive sentence structures, and words like 'leverage' and 'utilize' that no human actually speaks. Recruiters increasingly notice and discount this.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Read your resume aloud — if a sentence sounds like something you'd never actually say, rewrite it.
2. Replace inflated words with plain ones: 'utilize' → 'use,' 'leverage' → 'use,' 'facilitate' → 'help.'
3. Vary sentence length and structure — avoid every bullet following the identical rhythm.
4. Run a grammar check (Grammarly or similar) for tense consistency, subject-verb agreement, and punctuation.
5. Remove redundant words and filler phrases ('in order to' → 'to').
6. Have a human — not just AI — do a final read for tone and authenticity.

PRO TIPS

- Keep a personal 'banned words' list (utilize, synergy, leverage, dynamic, passionate) and search for them before finalizing.
- AI tends to overuse em-dashes and parallel three-item lists — vary structure manually after drafting.
- Read your resume back-to-back with a job description — if the language sounds identical to corporate boilerplate, humanize it.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Accepting AI-generated text without adjusting word choice to match your natural voice.
- Over-formalizing simple statements ('facilitated cross-functional synergy' instead of 'worked with 3 teams').
- Skipping a grammar tool pass entirely and relying only on manual proofreading.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Grammar & Humanization Pass

```
ROLE
You are an editor specializing in making AI-assisted resumes sound natural, human, and specific.

GOAL
Review my resume text for robotic phrasing, inflated vocabulary, grammar errors, and repetitive structure — then rewrite flagged sections.

CONTEXT
[Paste resume text.]

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. Do you want a light touch (grammar only) or a full humanization pass (tone + grammar)?
2. Is there a specific tone you want (confident, warm, technical, formal)?

RESTRICTIONS
- Do not change any factual claim, tool, or number.
- Flag every instance of inflated/corporate jargon (leverage, utilize, synergy, dynamic).
- Preserve my original meaning — humanize the phrasing, not the substance.

OUTPUT FORMAT
1. Grammar/Tense Issues (list with corrections)
2. Robotic Phrases Flagged (with humanized rewrite)
3. Final Cleaned Version of the full text

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm the rewritten version preserves every original fact and number exactly.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "too casual now," dial phrasing back toward formal without reintroducing jargon.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Flagged: "Utilized cross-functional synergies to facilitate project delivery" → Humanized: "Worked with the design and backend teams to

deliver the project on time"

Grammar: Bullet mixes past and present tense in the same role → standardized to past tense throughout.

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Resume read aloud for natural phrasing check
- ☐ Inflated/jargon words replaced with plain language
- ☐ Sentence structure varied across bullets
- ☐ Grammar tool pass completed
- ☐ Final human read-through for tone and authenticity

Polish should make you sound like the best version of yourself, not like every other AI-generated resume. Humanize after you optimize.

21

Interview Preparation: From Resume to Conversation

WHY IT MATTERS

A great resume gets you the interview; it doesn't get you the offer. Every claim on your resume becomes a question in the interview — preparation means being ready to expand on everything you wrote.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Re-read your own resume and prepare a 60-90 second spoken story for every bullet, project, and experience listed.
2. Prepare 3-5 STAR-format stories (Situation, Task, Action, Result) covering teamwork, challenge, failure, and leadership.
3. Research the company's products, recent news, and mission — prepare 2-3 thoughtful questions to ask them.
4. Practice explaining technical projects to both a technical and a non-technical audience.
5. Do at least one mock interview, recorded if possible, and review your filler words and pacing.
6. Prepare a concise answer to 'Tell me about yourself' that mirrors your resume summary, expanded to 60-90 seconds.

PRO TIPS

- Never let a resume claim be the first time you're thinking through how to explain it — prep every single line.
- For technical roles, be ready to walk through your project's actual code or architecture, not just describe it at a high level.
- Prepare one specific, well-researched question about the team/role — generic questions ('what's the culture like?') read as low-effort.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Memorizing scripted answers word-for-word — this sounds robotic and falls apart under follow-up questions.
- Failing to prepare a STAR story for a 'tell me about a failure' question — this catches almost everyone off guard.
- Asking zero questions when given the chance — this signals low genuine interest.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Interview Practice Partner

ROLE
You are a technical + behavioral interview coach conducting a realistic mock interview.

GOAL
Ask me a mix of behavioral and role-specific technical questions based on my resume, then give feedback on each answer.

CONTEXT
My resume: [paste]. Target role and company: [details]. Interview round type: [HR screen / technical / final].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. Which round are we simulating — HR screening, technical, or final panel?
2. Do you want questions strictly from my resume, or general role-based questions too?
3. Do you want feedback after each answer or at the end of the full mock?

RESTRICTIONS
- Ask one question at a time; wait for my answer before the next.
- Base at least half the questions directly on specific resume content.
- Give honest, specific feedback — not just "good answer."

OUTPUT FORMAT
Question → [wait for my answer] → Feedback (what was strong, what to improve) → Next question.

QUALITY CHECKS
Confirm feedback references specific words/structure from my actual answer, not generic tips.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "harder questions," increase technical depth or add unexpected follow-up probes.

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

AI: "Walk me through the onion price prediction project — specifically, how did you handle seasonal variation in the data?"

[Your answer]

Feedback: "Good technical detail on feature engineering. Next time, open with the business problem in one sentence before diving into the method — right now you start mid-technical, which can lose a non-technical interviewer."

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ 60-90 second story prepared for every resume bullet
- ☐ 3-5 STAR stories prepared across common themes
- ☐ Company research done, 2-3 questions prepared to ask
- ☐ At least one mock interview completed
- ☐ 'Tell me about yourself' answer rehearsed

Your resume opens the door; your ability to explain it clearly walks you through it. Prepare every claim as if it will be asked about — because it will.

The Final Resume Generator: Assembling Everything

WHY IT MATTERS

After building each section separately across previous chapters, this final step assembles everything into one cohesive, polished document — checked for consistency in tone, tense, and formatting.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Gather your finished Summary, Skills, Projects, Experience, Education, and Certifications sections.
2. Assemble in the order determined in Chapter 2 (Resume Structure).
3. Run a full-document consistency pass: fonts, spacing, bullet style, date format.
4. Run the ATS Compatibility Checker (Chapter 1) one final time on the assembled document.
5. Run the Resume Scorecard (Chapter 15) on the complete resume.
6. Export as PDF (text-selectable) and save with a clear filename.

PRO TIPS

- Build your Master Resume first, unoptimized for any single job — then create 2-3 minute tailored copies per application.
- Keep a version history (v1, v2, v3) so you can revert if an edit makes things worse.
- Have your resume reviewed by someone outside your field — if they can understand your projects, an HR generalist can too.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Assembling sections without a final consistency pass — mismatched fonts and spacing are common at this stage.
- Skipping the final ATS and Scorecard check after assembly, assuming individual sections were already checked.
- Saving over your Master Resume when tailoring for a specific job, losing your baseline version.

COPYABLE AI PROMPT

Full Resume Assembly & Final Check

```
ROLE
You are a senior resume editor performing the final assembly and quality check before submission.

GOAL
Assemble my finished sections into one cohesive resume, check for consistency, and confirm submission-readiness.

CONTEXT
[Paste each finished section: Summary, Skills, Projects, Experience, Education, Certifications.] Target role: [ROLE].

QUESTIONS TO ASK ME
1. Is this your Master Resume or a version tailored for one specific job?
2. Do you want a strict formatting audit included in this pass?
3. Any section you're still unsure about?

RESTRICTIONS
- Do not rewrite content that's already strong — only fix consistency and formatting issues.
- Flag any tense, date-format, or bullet-style inconsistency across sections.
- Confirm one-page length unless I state otherwise.

OUTPUT FORMAT
1. Assembled resume (full text, ready to format in Word/Docs)
2. Consistency Issues Found & Fixed
3. Final Readiness Confirmation (Ready / Needs One More Pass)

QUALITY CHECKS
Re-run keyword and formatting checks on the assembled version, not just individual sections.

REVISION INSTRUCTIONS
If I say "tailor this for [specific job]," adjust only the Summary and Skills emphasis, not the full structure.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

SAMPLE AI RESPONSE

Consistency Issues Found & Fixed:

- Experience section used "Jan 2024" while Certifications used "January 2024" → standardized to "Jan 2024" format throughout

- Projects section bullets used periods at the end, Experience section did not → standardized to no periods

Final Readiness: Ready for submission

ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ All sections assembled in correct order
- ☐ Full-document consistency pass completed
- ☐ ATS Compatibility Checker re-run on full document
- ☐ Resume Scorecard re-run on full document
- ☐ Exported as text-selectable PDF with clear filename

Assembly is where small inconsistencies hide. One final pass across the whole document — not just each section — is what makes a resume feel genuinely polished.

Three ATS-Ready Resume Templates

Use these as a starting skeleton. Fill each bracketed section using the prompts and chapters in this book, then run the Resume Scorecard before submitting.

Template A — Technical Fresher (ML/Data/Software)

HEADER
Full Name | Phone | Email | LinkedIn | GitHub | Location

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY
[3 lines: identity, 2-3 skills, one proof point]

SKILLS
Languages: ...
Frameworks & Tools: ...
Concepts: ...

PROJECTS
Project 1 (Tech Stack)
- Bullet / Bullet / Bullet
Project 2 (Tech Stack)
- Bullet / Bullet / Bullet
Project 3 (Tech Stack)
- Bullet / Bullet / Bullet

EXPERIENCE / INTERNSHIPS
Company — Role (Month Year - Month Year)
- Bullet / Bullet / Bullet

EDUCATION
Degree, Specialization — University (Year) — CGPA

CERTIFICATIONS
- Certificate — Platform (Year)

ACHIEVEMENTS
- Achievement with scale/rank

Template B — Business/Consulting Fresher

HEADER
Full Name | Phone | Email | LinkedIn | Location

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY
[3 lines: identity, domain focus, one proof point]

CORE SKILLS
Domain Skills: ...
Tools: Excel, PowerPoint, SAP, Power BI ...
Soft Skills: Stakeholder communication, client reporting ...

EXPERIENCE / INTERNSHIPS
Company — Role (Month Year - Month Year)
- Bullet / Bullet / Bullet

PROJECTS / CASE STUDIES
Project Title
- Bullet / Bullet / Bullet

EDUCATION
Degree — University (Year) — CGPA

CERTIFICATIONS
- Certificate — Platform (Year)

ACHIEVEMENTS & LEADERSHIP
- Achievement with scale/rank

Template C — Minimal One-Page Universal

NAME
Phone | Email | LinkedIn | Portfolio

SUMMARY (3 lines)

SKILLS (single line, comma-separated, 10-14 items)

EXPERIENCE
Role, Company (Dates)

- Bullet / Bullet / Bullet

PROJECTS

Title (Tech Stack) — Bullet / Bullet

EDUCATION

Degree, University (Year)

CERTIFICATIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Line / Line / Line

Master Resume Checklist & HR Review Checklist

CANDIDATE-SIDE: RESUME CHECKLIST

- ☐ One page (unless 3+ years experience)
- ☐ Standard, ATS-safe section headings used
- ☐ No tables, columns, graphics, or text boxes
- ☐ Consistent date format across all sections
- ☐ Every bullet starts with an action verb
- ☐ Every bullet shows outcome, not just task
- ☐ 8-12 job description keywords present
- ☐ No generic filler adjectives (hardworking, passionate)
- ☐ Contact info correct and clickable (email, LinkedIn)
- ☐ File saved as FirstName_LastName_Resume.pdf
- ☐ Spell-check and grammar-check completed
- ☐ Reviewed by at least one other person

RECRUITER-SIDE: THE HR CHECKLIST

Run your own resume through these questions as if you were the recruiter reviewing it cold.

- ☐ Does the summary state a clear, specific identity?
- ☐ Are the top 3 skills immediately visible within 6 seconds?
- ☐ Do project/experience bullets show ownership and outcome?
- ☐ Is there at least one quantified achievement?
- ☐ Would this resume survive a keyword search for the target role?
- ☐ Is the formatting clean enough to trust the candidate's attention to detail?
- ☐ Are there any inconsistencies (dates, tenses, punctuation) that raise doubt?
- ☐ Does the candidate's LinkedIn match and reinforce the resume?
- ☐ Is there any unexplained gap or oddity that would raise a question?
- ☐ Overall: would this resume earn a follow-up call?

Action Verb Bank, Certification Platforms & AI Tools

RESUME ACTION VERBS, BY CATEGORY

Building & Creating

- Built
- Designed
- Developed
- Engineered
- Launched
- Created
- Architected

Improving & Optimizing

- Improved
- Optimized
- Streamlined
- Automated
- Reduced
- Increased
- Enhanced

Leading & Collaborating

- Led
- Coordinated
- Mentored
- Facilitated
- Organized
- Partnered
- Directed

Analyzing & Solving

- Analyzed
- Researched
- Diagnosed
- Evaluated
- Investigated
- Modeled
- Forecasted

Delivering & Executing

- Delivered
- Implemented
- Executed
- Shipped
- Deployed
- Achieved
- Completed

FREE CERTIFICATION PLATFORMS

Platform	Why It's Worth It
NPTel	Free university-backed courses with certification exams; highly trusted by Indian recruiters.
Coursera	University and industry partner courses (Google, IBM, Meta); free audit, paid certificate.
Google Skillshop / Career Certificates	Free, industry-recognized certificates in Analytics, UX, IT Support.
AWS Skill Builder	Free foundational cloud courses; Cloud Practitioner path is fresher-friendly.
Microsoft Learn	Free, self-paced learning paths for Azure, Power Platform, and productivity tools.
Kaggle Learn	Free, hands-on micro-courses in Python, ML, and data visualization.
freeCodeCamp	Free, project-based certifications in web development and data analysis.
HackerRank / LeetCode	Skill certifications and practice for technical interview readiness.

USEFUL AI TOOLS FOR THIS SYSTEM

Tool	Best Used For
Claude	Long-context drafting, resume/prompt workflows, document generation.
ChatGPT	General drafting, brainstorming, quick iteration.
Grammarly	Grammar, tone, and clarity pass after AI drafting.
Canva	Optional visual assets for LinkedIn banners — not for ATS resumes.
Teal / Jobscan	ATS keyword match scoring against job descriptions.
Notion / Google Docs	Master resume version control and organization.

The Grammarly Workflow

A quick, repeatable process for the final polish pass on any AI-drafted text — resume, cover letter, or LinkedIn About section.

1. Paste your AI-drafted or human-written resume text into Grammarly (or similar tool).
2. Set the tone goal to 'Confident' and 'Formal' if available.
3. Accept all grammar and spelling corrections first — these are objective.
4. Review tone/clarity suggestions individually — don't accept all automatically, some change meaning.
5. Re-read the corrected version aloud to confirm it still sounds like you.
6. Run a final check specifically for passive voice and replace with active voice.